

# UPSC Civil Services (Main) Simulation GS-I

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

## INSTRUCTIONS

1. There are TWENTY questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. Questions 1-10 carry 10 marks each and should be answered in 150 words.
3. Questions 11-20 carry 15 marks each and should be answered in 250 words.
4. Answers must remain relevant to the demand and use appropriate examples.

Q1. Explain glacier mass balance and the apparent paradox of a retreating yet forward-flowing glacier.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q2. Explain how wind and episodic water jointly create arid landforms.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q3. Distinguish mineral-resource geography from energy geography with suitable Indian examples.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q4. Explain how caste is assuming new identities and associational forms in contemporary India.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q5. Contrast the isolationist, assimilationist and integrationist positions in Indian tribal policy.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q6. How did pre-Congress political associations prepare the ground for the Indian National Congress?

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q7. Why was Champaran a methodological turning point in India's national movement?

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q8. Explain why the founding leadership deferred linguistic reorganisation between 1947 and 1948 although the Congress had accepted the linguistic principle since 1921.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q9. Why should temple vocabulary be read as a grammar of movement and hierarchy rather than as a decorative glossary?

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q10. Why did the fiscal crisis become a social revolution in France?

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q11. Account for the world distribution of hot and mid-latitude deserts.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q12. Analyse the dual role of the summer maritime mechanism in making eastern-margin regions both agriculturally rich and hazard-prone.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q13. Examine the significance of straits, canals and isthmuses in international trade.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q14. Cultural diversity in India marks disadvantage but does not produce it. Critically examine.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q15. Examine the claim that Indian kinship is uniform, using matrilineal evidence.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q16. Compare British policy toward Afghanistan and Burma.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q17. Was Gandhi's withdrawal after Chauri Chaura a strategic necessity or a lost opportunity? Examine.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q18. Compare Junagadh, Hyderabad and Kashmir as three distinct failures of the accession formula rather than three versions of one problem.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q19. Regional adaptation, not imperial imitation, best explains provincial Indo-Islamic architecture. Discuss.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q20. Was the Concert of Europe an instrument of peace or repression?

[15 marks | 250 words]

END OF PAPER